

Effect of Early Mobilisation After Surgery

Background: early mobilisation is recommended after abdominal surgery, but the evidence for its effect on length of stay is mixed. We reviewed 240 patients treated between 2021 and 2023 at a single teaching hospital.

Methods

Patients were grouped by the day of first walk. The primary outcome was length of hospital stay; secondary outcomes were readmission and pneumonia within 30 days.

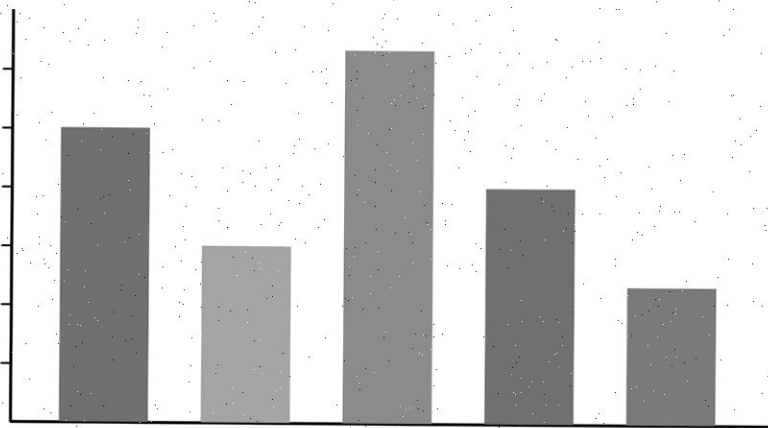


Figure 1. Mean length of stay by group.

Results

Patients who walked on day one went home sooner, with fewer complications.

Table 1. Baseline characteristics

Group	Patients	Mean age	Stay (days)
Day 1	96	54.2	4.1
Day 2	88	57.9	5.3
Day 3+	56	61.4	7.8

Readmission was lowest in the day-one group. The difference in pneumonia rates was not statistically significant ($p = 0.08$).

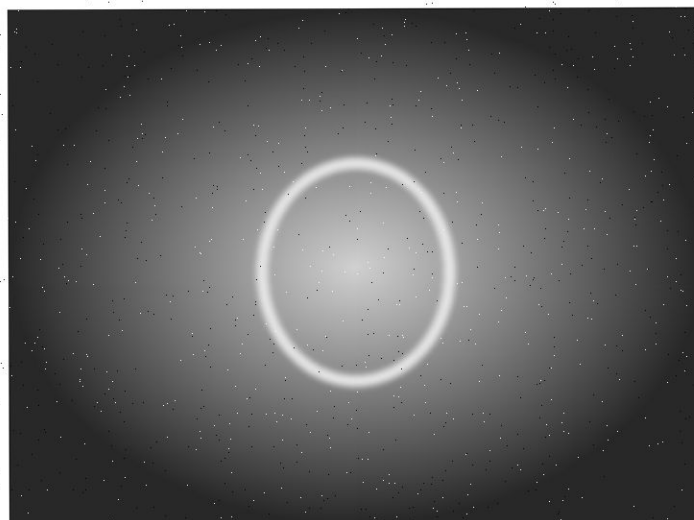


Figure 2. Chest radiograph of a typical patient.

Conclusion

Walking on the first day after surgery is safe and shortens the hospital stay.